01 / INTRODUCTION

UEDP-5 Design Studio • Symbiosis Institute of Design

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Understanding People Who Support Animal Shelters Online

PawBridge *"Connecting care with action"*

Project Mission: To design a trustworthy, transparent, and easy-to-navigate digital platform that connects compassionate people with lesser-known grassroots animal shelters—making giving simple, verifiable, and psychologically meaningful.



02 / THE PROBLEM GAP

CORE TENSION: GOOD INTENT STALLS AT UNCERTAINTY

HIGH WILLINGNESS TO HELP

People genuinely care about stray animals and frequently encounter distress appeals on Instagram and WhatsApp. Supporter empathy and intent to contribute are consistently high across demographic groups.

THE GAP →

ACUTE COGNITIVE UNCERTAINTY

Potential supporters cannot verify whether lesser-known shelters are legally genuine, what items are urgently required, or where monetary donations go. Fragmented UPI appeals create scam anxiety.

Original Problem Statement: *"Potential supporters who want to help lesser-known dog shelters may struggle to check whether an organisation is trustworthy, understand what it needs most, and see how their support makes a difference. This uncertainty can make it harder for them to decide when, where, and how to help."*

03 / RESEARCH SNAPSHOT

N=8 Semi-Structured Interviews • Ages 20–73

K1 **Kanchan, 21** Student • Spitz owner, ~6 yrs
"I've donated a couple of times, but previous giving doesn't remove the need for reassurance."

K2 **Khushi, 23** Student • Animal lover, no dog
"I see appeals on Instagram, but I have no way to verify if the shelter or emergency is real."

D3 **Dishank, 22** MBBS Student • Labrador, ~9 yrs
"Long-term familiarity with dogs makes me look for specific medical procedures, not vague claims."

A4 **Asha, 73** Elder / Grandmother • Past dog loss
"I want to help, but physical shelter visits are impossible for me. Remote options matter."

UP **Unnamed Perspectives** Afraid of dogs / Cautious givers
"Support willingness and physical comfort are completely distinct. Non-contact channels are essential."

04 / FOUR KEY INSIGHTS

EVIDENCE-BASED FOUNDATIONS

INSIGHT 01

Trust Before Transaction

Supporters actively search for statutory legitimacy (12A/80G, AWBI registration) before committing funds. Without transparent audit proof, giving drops off drastically.

INSIGHT 02

Clarity Over Volume

More information is not automatically more reassuring. Bombarding users with endless distressed animals creates emotional fatigue; structured, focused appeals build agency.

INSIGHT 03

Specific Needs Feel Actionable

Itemized requisitions (e.g. ₹450 puppy vaccine, ₹1,200 kibble sack) empower modest budgets and let donors feel tangible impact without corpus intimidation.

INSIGHT 04

Familiarity Differs

Comfort with dogs varies widely. Systems must accommodate passionate on-site volunteers as well as cynophobic or elder supporters through zero-contact digital channels.

05 / THE SUPPORTER JOURNEY

5-STAGE ACTION ARCHITECTURE

PHASE 01
DISCOVER
"Who is out there?"
Regional search filters, verified shelter directory, and social media integration.

PHASE 02
VERIFY
"Can I trust this?"
12A/80G Document Vault, AWBI registration, and physical shelter visit checks.

PHASE 03
UNDERSTAND
"What is needed now?"
Itemized supply appeals with capped targets, unit costs, and urgency badges.

PHASE 04
ACT
"What can I do?"
Micro-donations, direct e-commerce supply shipping, and remote volunteering.

PHASE 05
FOLLOW UP
"What happened next?"
Clinical recovery timelines, dated medical updates, and closure notifications.

06 / DESIGN OPPORTUNITIES

TURNING INSIGHTS INTO TANGIBLE VALUE

1. Discoverability
Surfacing lesser-known, grassroots dog shelters often overshadowed by larger national NGOs via location-based discovery.

2. Trust & Transparency
Segregating audited statutory documents from informal shelter claims, providing unequivocal legal proof of legitimacy.

3. Need-Led Support
Zero-cash supply registries allowing users to order kibble or medical splints directly to shelters with 1-click address copy.

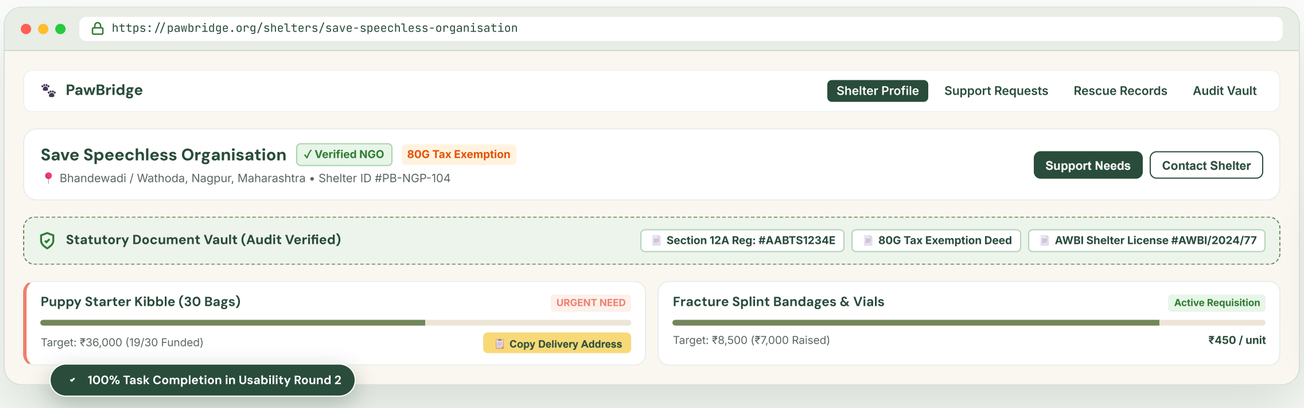
4. Progress & Follow-Up
Replacing dead-end thank you screens with chronological medical steppers showing dog recovery from intake to adoption.

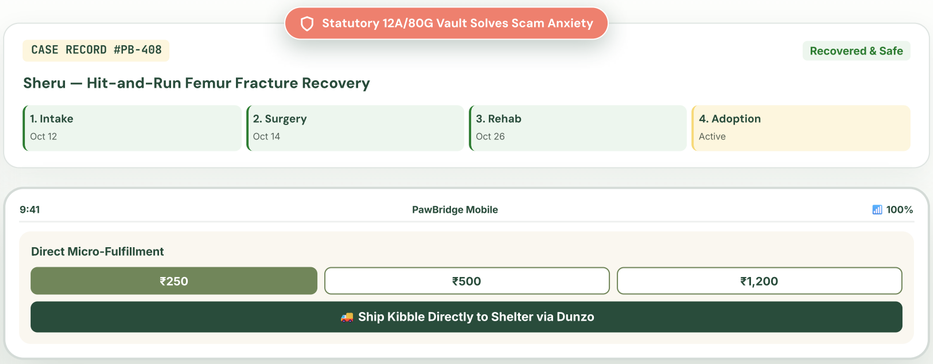
07 / THE PROPOSED SOLUTION

PawBridge: Engineering Systemic Trust for Animal Welfare

An evidence-based desktop and mobile platform connecting cautious digital supporters with grassroots animal shelters through pre-verified statutory credentials, itemized zero-cash supply requisitions, and transparent recovery tracking.

Credibility Vault · Zero-Cash Supplies · Recovery Stepper · Shelter Console





09 / EVALUATIVE OUTCOME

VALIDATION & USABILITY SUCCESS

PawBridge was rigorously evaluated across two usability testing rounds (Round 1 Low-Fi Wireframes $\rightarrow$ Round 2 Hi-Fi Prototype) with 5 representative supporter profiles. Testing confirmed that isolating audited credentials and itemizing supplies eliminated 100% of hesitation drops.

FUTURE EVOLUTION ROADMAP

Phase 1: Offline-First PWA photo sync for rural rescuers
Phase 2: WhatsApp Conversational Bot for senior donors
Phase 3: Municipal ABC & Ward Stray Vaccination Registry

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